**SheSignals website one single page copy**

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- Logo is TRANSPARENT BACKGROUND and In PINK COLOR
- All Headings are Pink as noted here.
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SheSignals

## Empowering Early Detection of Autism in Girls

## Welcome to SheSignals

At SheSignals, we are dedicated to helping parents, educators, and clinicians recognize early signs of autism in girls, a population often overlooked due to subtle or masked presentations. Through precise screening tools and a deeper understanding of gender-specific behaviors, SheSignals strives to enable early support, intervention, and empowerment.

## Our Mission:

To close the diagnostic gap and foster early, accurate identification of autism in girls, allowing them to thrive with timely support.

## Why Early Detection of Autism in Girls Matters

Early detection of autism in girls is critical because autistic traits in females often present differently, more subtly, or are intentionally masked compared to males. Without early identification, girls are at higher risk of experiencing chronic mental health challenges, and delayed access to crucial support systems. Moreover, girls with autism are frequently misdiagnosed or diagnosed later than boys.

Early recognition in girls can be life-changing. It dramatically improves developmental outcomes by enabling access to therapies, support systems, and educational accommodations when they are most impactful.

It is the key to unlocking strengths, navigating challenges, and building a future where autistic girls are fully seen and supported. Early diagnosis is not just about labeling—it is about opening doors to understanding, authentic support, and healthier futures for autistic girls.

## Facts about Autism in Girls

1. On average, women experience a 10-year delay in receiving an autism diagnosis from their first presentation to mental health services? This delay is particularly evident in women who exhibit more nuanced autistic traits and do not have intellectual disabilities.

2. A questionnaire conducted by the Autistic Girls Network found that 43% of autistic girls waited up to two years for a diagnosis, while 24% waited more than three years.

3. Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) is diagnosed more frequently in males than females, with traditional estimates suggesting a 4:1 male-to-female ratio. However, recent research indicates that this disparity may be due to under-diagnosis in females. Studies have found that nearly 80% of autistic females remain undiagnosed by age 18.

4. In the United States, approximately 1 in 36 child is diagnosed with autism. Boys are nearly four times more likely to be diagnosed than girls, with about 4 in 100 boys and 1 in 100 girls identified as having autism.

5. A 2022 study published in *Autism Research* found that autistic girls are more likely to first be misdiagnosed with anxiety, depression, borderline personality disorder, or eating disorders before receiving an autism diagnosis.

6. Almost 50% of autistic females surveyed reported receiving a mental health diagnosis *before*

their autism was identified.

7. A 2021 meta-analysis found that late-diagnosed autistic women were three times more likely to experience major depressive disorder, self-harm, or suicidality compared to early-diagnosed individuals.

8. Boys are diagnosed with autism at much higher rates than girls. According to research, about 1 in 42 boys (around 2.4%) are diagnosed with autism, whereas 1 in 189 girls (around 0.5%) are diagnosed. This means boys are about four times more likely to be diagnosed early compared to girls.

## Our Screening Approach

SheSignals offers a comprehensive, girl-centered early detection framework:

1. Neurodevelopmental history collection
2. Sensory processing pattern analysis
3. Social communication and emotional regulation screening
4. Masking and camouflaging behavior identification
5. Parent, caregiver, and educator collaboration
6. Our questions and explanations are tailored to uncover nuanced indicators often missed in standard screening models.

## Sample Screening Focus Areas

1. Developmental Milestones
Why Important: Age-specific expectations help differentiate transient delays from persistent neurodevelopmental patterns.

2. Social Reciprocity and Friendships
Why Important: Superficial social fluency can mask deep struggles with peer interactions.

3. Emotional and Sensory Regulation
Why Important: Subtle internalized distress can precede overt signs of anxiety and depression.

4. Masking and Camouflaging Behaviors
Why Important: Girls often work hard to mimic typical behaviors, leading to later or missed diagnoses.

5. Family and Medical History

Why Important: Genetic and perinatal factors provide critical diagnostic context.

## Autism Screening Assessment

BUTTON with text ->**TAKE SCREENING**<-
<Clicking on this button takes you to the Screening page>

## Advisors

**Lauren Levinson**
Bay Area Friendship Circle

**Sydney Zitzer**
Pacific Autism Center for Education

## Resources to Download

Please note that these resources are for your early awareness. These are not for diagnostic. Our recommendations are meant to encourage you to engage with a qualified medical professional for a timely follow-up.

**38 Questions Screening for Parents and Teachers <links to a PDF Questions W Explanation.pdf>**

**A Guidebook for Parents <links to a PDF Parents_Guidebook>**

## Our Technology

SheSignals uses a layered machine learning approach to analyze structured responses from parents, guardians, and educators across 38 behavioral and developmental indicators. Our models include Logistic Regression for interpretable probability scoring, Random Forests for identifying complex behavioral interactions, and Gradient Boosting methods such as XGBoost to improve prediction accuracy across subtle response patterns that are often harder to detect in girls. By combining these approaches, the system generates a confidence-based recommendation that helps families determine whether seeking a specialist evaluation may be beneficial. The technology is designed

to support early awareness and professional follow-up, not replace clinical diagnosis.

## Books We Recommend

1. How to be Autistic by Rachel Morgan-Trimmer
2. Autism in Heels: The Untold Story of a female life on the spectrum by Jennifer Cook O'Toole
3. But You Don't Look Autistic At All by Bianca Toeps
4. Nobody Nowhere by Donna Williams

## Contact Us

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**Screening form webpage copy**

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SheSignals

Fill out the screening form below to request a prediction from our technology

| Question | Options |
|---|---|
| Question | Options |
| … | … |

Submit Form | Clear Form

**BACK TO HOMEPAGE**